

Venu Srinivasan – A Legacy of Quality, Vision & Leadership

In a recent move TVS Motor's Venu Srinivasan was bestowed the prestigious 2025 CII Quality Ratna Award for pioneering quality leadership and advancing India's manufacturing capabilities.

The award is a timely reminder of Venu Srinivasan's incredible five-decade legacy in building TVS Motor Company from a small maker of mopeds to a global brand. The globally renowned doyen of industry has been feted down the years for his exemplary contributions in India achieving the manufacturing benchmarks that match global heft.

As the world's eyes turn increasingly for inspiration to the nation's "Made in India" initiative, Venu Srinivasan's pursuit of manufacturing excellence resonates with us even more deeply today. It serves as an inspirational imperative for those who follow in his steps to transform India, as envisioned, into one of the world's top three manufacturing hubs. India's current share in global manufacturing is around 3 percent.

TVS Motor, an Indian multinational motorcycle manufacturer, is the flagship of the TVS Group, founded in 1911 by T. V. Sundaram Iyengar. Venu Srinivasan, his grandson is now Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motor. Sundaram-Clayton, the holding company of the TVS Group, is involved in manufacturing components for vehicles. Venu Srinivasan's visionary leadership also witnessed partnerships with BMW Motorrad and the acquisition of Norton Motorcycles.

Decades ago, well ahead of the 'Make in India' initiative, Venu Srinivasan set a new trajectory for India's automotive sector by introducing Total

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Quality Management (TQM) practices at TVS Motor, the third-largest two-wheeler manufacturer in India. The TQM practices were inspired by Japanese systems in which the management approach is focused on long-term success through customer satisfaction, involving all members of an organization in improving processes, products, services, and the culture in which they work. Venu Srinivasan was the first Industrialist from India to be conferred with the Deming 'Distinguished Service Award for Dissemination and Promotion Overseas' in 2019, for his contributions in the field of TQM.

Under his leadership TVS Motor was the first Indian auto firm to achieve global certifications. It was the first two-wheeler company outside Japan to win the Deming Prize in 2002; this unique achievement set a gold standard for Indian manufacturing.

Mr Srinivasan's worldview has long encompassed the thinking behind 'Make in India' and 'Atmanirbhar Bharat', as TVS marked its export growth, industrial and global competitiveness under his leadership down the decades.

Srinivasan's people-centric vision has played a pivotal role in the company's growth. It was his firm belief that designs should be led by customer needs. Looking at the company's internal heft, he would point out that employee trust is fundamental to long-term success. His views resonate with the contemporary industrial ethos that is surfacing globally— that value creation, employee engagement, and customer satisfaction are intrinsic to holistic growth and progress. Taking the podium at the 33rd CII Excellence Summit in Kolkata he pointed out that "Technology and social aspirations are driving new products. We must deeply understand customer needs and serve them for a lifetime."

While accepting another lifetime achievements award he quietly emphasised a long-held view that "TVS Motor's success is not because of the strategic decisions I made, or will make, but because of the people who stand by the company."

Today Venu Srinivasan's influence extends across manufacturing, finance, and philanthropy in India.